

CORNALES

Seven families constitute the revised order Cornales. Five of these are small and relatively insignificant, one with just a single species of evergreen tree from Africa. The main family is the dogwood family (Cornaceae), a loose taxonomic grouping of shrubs and small trees found in temperate zones and on tropical mountains. The hydrangea family (Hydrangeaceae) includes several popular garden plants.



HYDRANGEA
Hydrangea macrophylla
F: Hydrangeaceae

Native to Japan, this showy shrub is cultivated for its rounded clusters of rose, lavender, blue, and even white flowers.

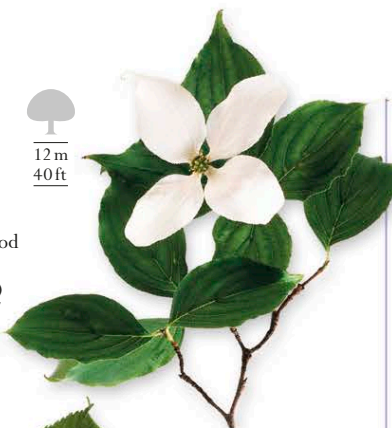
1.5 m/5 ft

FLOWERING DOGWOOD

Cornus florida
F: Cornaceae

The showy white "petals" of this N. American dogwood tree are bracts (specialized leaves) around clusters of tiny flowers.

12 m
40 ft



25 m
80 ft

DOVE TREE

Davidia involucrata
F: Nyssaceae

This small flowering tree from China is impressive in bloom, with flowerheads 2 cm (¾ in) across, surrounded by creamy bracts.

MOCK ORANGE

Philadelphus sp.
F: Hydrangeaceae

Around 45 species of this shrubby genus, named for their orange-blossom fragrance, are native to Asia, western N. America, and Mexico.



4.5 m
15 ft

ERICALES

Comprising 22 families, the Ericales is a major order, both economically and as one of the world's main herbaceous groups. It is named after its largest member, the heather family (Ericaceae), with over 4,000 species of flowering shrubs mainly in acid soils. It also includes 900 species in the primrose family (Primulaceae), largely confined to north temperate mountain regions; herbs and shrubs in the Jacob's ladder family (Polemoniaceae); and carnivorous plants in the pitcher plant family (Sarracenaceae).



1 m
3¼ ft

JACOB'S LADDER

Polemonium caeruleum
F: Polemoniaceae

This tall perennial has cup-shaped lavender or white flowers. It grows in rocky and grassy places in Europe and N. Asia.



1 m/3¼ ft

PERENNIAL PHLOX

Phlox paniculata
F: Polemoniaceae

A pyramidal cluster of trumpet-shaped, pink or lavender flowers top the stem of this perennial, native to open woods in S.E. USA.